

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 1045

By Pody

A RESOLUTION to commend D.T. McCall & Sons of Middle Tennessee.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should applaud those Tennessee businesses that have a longstanding commitment to providing exceptional service to their customers; and

WHEREAS, one such estimable entity is D.T. McCall & Sons, which has ably served the citizens of Middle Tennessee for more than 100 years; and

WHEREAS, D.T. McCall & Sons traces its beginnings back to 1896, when Albert and Icie McCall opened their general store in Flat Rock; their son, D.T. McCall, was a salesman, and their grandson, Albert Burr McCall, Sr., helped in the store during the summer; and

WHEREAS, after time as a salesman at his parent's store, D.T. McCall began his own business using a horse and buggy to go to homes throughout Smith County, buying and selling produce and other goods; he brought the first electric ranges to Carthage, and in the late 1930s, he bought a corner lot on the town square, where he opened a furniture and appliance store; and

WHEREAS, his son, Albert McCall, earned a bachelor's degree in agriculture from Tennessee Technological University in 1950 and a master's degree in animal nutrition from the University of Missouri in 1951; he taught agriculture for one year at Winterset High School in Iowa before serving as a Second Lieutenant and forward observer in the Korean War, ultimately being discharged at the rank of First Lieutenant; and

WHEREAS, he returned to Iowa following his military service, and it was there he met his future wife, Virginia; the couple moved to Albert McCall's native Carthage, where he bought

into his father's furniture and appliance business, joined by his brothers, Dave McCall and John McCall, and his nephew, Tom McCall; and

WHEREAS, Albert McCall proved himself motivated and industrious; he was an expert at finding and creating opportunities to source products at low prices, which led the business's growth and allowed him to pass savings on to customers; and

WHEREAS, in 1958, he learned that a local cheese company was changing its manufacturing process, which meant that 1,700 dairy farmers would need new industrial milk coolers to continue to supply the company with milk; further research showed that North Carolina had recently outlawed the exact type of cooler that the Tennessee manufacturer required, so after several trips East, he bought 1,000 coolers and had them shipped by truck to Tennessee. On the way back, they stopped in South Carolina to fill the coolers with peaches to sell back in Carthage; and

WHEREAS, in 1959, Albert McCall discovered that 500 commercial size Korean-War-surplus electric ranges were available from a company in Akron, Ohio, a part of Ohio that used primarily natural gas for heating and cooling, while TVA provided electricity for Middle Tennessee; he bought the ranges for a great price and passed the savings along to various schools in the State; and

WHEREAS, when oil prices fell in 1984, large inventories of household furnishings that were originally intended for condos in Saudi Arabia were sitting in a warehouse in Houston, Texas, and up for auction; Mr. McCall traveled to Houston to buy the full inventory, moving thirty-seven truckloads in seven days, ultimately passing along the savings to his customers while also making a good profit; and

WHEREAS, for twenty years, Mr. McCall advertised on *The Ralph Emery Show* on Channel Four between 5:00 a.m. and 6:00 a.m.; his live commercials were so popular that Channel Four used them to promote the Emery show, resulting in business booming and Albert

McCall becoming a popular television personality in Channel Four's Middle Tennessee/Southern Kentucky/Northern Alabama viewing audience; and

WHEREAS, *The Ralph Emery Show* had the highest lead-in audience to *The Today Show* in the entire country, and D.T. McCall & Sons became the forty-ninth largest furniture and appliance store in the United States, according to *Home Furnishings Daily*, a magazine that also named D.T. McCall & Sons number one in the United States in profit per dollars' worth of sales at that time; and

WHEREAS, D.T. McCall & Sons currently serves customers at five locations throughout Middle Tennessee and is led by the fourth generation of the McCall family: Albert "AJ" McCall, Jr., Cris McCall, JJ McCall, and Frank McCall; and

WHEREAS, for more than a century, D.T. McCall & Sons has been providing superior products and customer service, and it is fitting that the business be commended; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we commend D.T. McCall & Sons for its many years of devoted service to the citizens of this State, extending our best wishes for much continued success in the future.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.